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阅读 C

“卷毛狗”老师的一堂课

记叙文 · 人物与成长 · 全文 418 词 · 逐句精读

¹ Our teacher, Miss Chevalier, was a small woman, with a moon face, plump fingers and curls that sprang straight up from her head, hence the funny name “Poodle (卷毛狗)”.

我们的老师谢瓦利埃小姐是个身材娇小的女人，圆圆的脸，手指胖乎乎的，一头卷发直直地竖在头上，因此有了“卷毛狗”这个滑稽的外号。

moon face 圆脸

plump adj. 胖乎乎的；丰满的

curl n. 卷发

sprang v. 弹起；（突然）竖起

straight up 直直向上

hence adv. 因此

funny adj. 滑稽的；好笑的

poodle n. 卷毛狗；贵宾犬

² She taught in our reading club.

她在我们的读书俱乐部教课。

reading club 读书俱乐部；读书会

³ Sometimes she would look in and ask what we were reading — not to check but to know.

有时她会进来看看，问我们在读什么——不是为了检查，而是想了解。

look in 进来看看；顺便探望

check v. 检查

⁴ That's what happened the day my club was reading aloud
a poem by Henry Longfellow.

我们俱乐部朗读亨利·朗费罗的一首诗那天，就发生了这样的事。

read aloud 朗读；大声读

poem n. 诗

⁵ I **guess** I was better than the others, **for** Miss Chevalier asked **a while later**, “Addie, **I was wondering if** you would **recite** the whole poem to the Saturday evening club.”

我想我读得比其他人好，因为过了一會兒，谢瓦利埃小姐问道：“艾迪，我在想，你愿不愿意在周六晚间俱乐部活动上背诵整首诗。”

guess v. 猜想；认为

for conj. 因为

a while later 过了一會兒

I was wondering if 我在想……是否（委婉请求）

recite v. 背诵；朗诵

⁶ She said a famous **professor** was going to **give a lecture** about the **poet**, and a **presentation** of that poem would be a **fresh** way to start.

她说，一位著名教授要来做一场关于这位诗人的讲座，而以朗诵那首诗来开场会很新颖。

professor n. 教授

give a lecture 做讲座

poet n. 诗人

presentation n. 表演；（诗歌的）朗诵

fresh adj. 新颖的；新鲜的

⁷ She asked me to **memorize** it.

她让我把这首诗背下来。

memorize v. 记住；背下来

⁸ “But that shouldn’t be a problem for a child of your **ability**,” she **added**.

“不过对于像你这样有能力的孩子来说，这应该不成问题，”她补充道。

ability n. 能力；才能

add v. 补充说；又说

9 I'm telling you, my happy feet **barely** touched the ground
all the way home.

说真的，回家的一路上，我高兴得脚都快不沾地了。

I'm telling you 说真的；告诉你吧

barely adv. 几乎不；勉强

all the way 一路上；一直

¹⁰ To me, that was the biggest thing ever and I soon **learned** the whole poem **by heart**, **well prepared for** our first **rehearsal**.

对我来说，那是我经历过的最了不起的事。我很快就把整首诗背得滚瓜烂熟，为第一次排练做好了充分准备。

learn...by heart 背熟；熟记

be well prepared for 为……做好充分准备

rehearsal n. 排练；彩排

¹¹ I was desperately nervous when I went to her office the next day.

第二天去她办公室时，我紧张得要命。

desperately adv. 极度地；非常

nervous adj. 紧张的

¹² But the good thing was she always had the smile that would make you feel like you just did something right.

不过好在她总是带着那种微笑，让你觉得自己好像刚做对了什么事。

the good thing was 好在

feel like 感觉像是；觉得好像

13 Halfway through the poem, Miss Chevalier stopped me and asked if I knew what “impetuous” meant.

诗背到一半时，谢瓦利埃小姐打断了我，问我知不知道“impetuous”是什么意思。

halfway through （进行）到一半

impetuous adj. 冲动的；猛烈的

14 **Despite** her **encouraging** smile, I wanted to **sink through the floor** because I was **unsure about** its **pronunciation** **as well as** its meaning.

尽管她带着鼓励的微笑，我还是恨不得找个地缝钻进去，因为这个词的读音和意思我都没有把握。

despite prep. 尽管

encouraging adj. 鼓励的

sink through the floor （羞得）恨不得钻到地下

be unsure about 对……没把握

pronunciation n. 发音；读音

as well as 以及；和

15 Miss Chevalier **pretended** not to have **noticed** my red face and **handed** me a dictionary, asking me to **read** the word's **definition** **aloud**.

谢瓦利埃小姐假装没注意到我涨红的脸，递给我一本词典，让我把这个词的释义大声读出来。

pretend v. 假装

notice v. 注意到

hand v. 递；交给

read...aloud 大声读；朗读

definition n. 释义；定义

¹⁶ “Impetuous has two definitions: **rushing** with great **force** or **violence**; acting suddenly, **with little thought**.”

“impetuous有两个释义：一是以巨大的力量或猛烈之势向前冲；二是行事突然，几乎不加思考。”

rush v. 冲；奔

force n. 力量

violence n. 猛烈；暴力

with little thought 几乎不加思考；草率

17 She asked me which one fitted the poem.

她问我哪一个释义符合诗中的意思。

fit v. 适合；符合

¹⁸ I read both definitions over again, trying to figure it out, but Miss Chevalier must have read my mind.

我把两个释义又读了一遍，想弄明白，但谢瓦利埃小姐一定是看出了我的心思。

over again 再一次

figure...out 弄明白；想出

must have （对过去的推测）一定……

read one's mind 看出某人的心思

19 “There is no wrong answer,” she said.

“怎么回答都不算错，”她说。

wrong adj. 错误的

20 “I want to know your **opinion**, Addie.”

“我想知道你的看法，艾迪。”

opinion n. 看法；意见

21 Hesitantly, I said, “Maybe... both.”

我犹豫地说：“也许……两个都是。”

hesitantly adv. 犹豫地；迟疑地

22 She **liked** that.

她喜欢这个回答。

like v. 喜欢；中意

²³ “One has to be impetuous **both ways** **or** one wouldn't **dare** to **face up to** any **challenge**.”

“一个人得在两种意义上都‘冲动’才行，否则就不敢直面任何挑战。”

both ways 两方面；两种意义上

or conj. 否则

dare v. 敢于

face up to 勇敢面对；直面

challenge n. 挑战

24 Would you call yourself impetuous?”

你会说自己是个冲动的人吗？”

call oneself 称自己为；认为自己是

impetuous adj. 冲动的；（做事）有冲劲的

25 I knew she was asking for an opinion.

我知道她是在征求我的看法。

ask for 征求；请求

opinion n. 看法；意见

26 “My mother thinks it is improper for girls to be impetuous, anyway.”

“反正我妈妈认为女孩子冲动是不得体的。”

improper adj. 不得体的；不恰当的

impetuous adj. 冲动的

anyway adv. 反正；无论如何

²⁷ She said my mom was somewhat right about that.

她说我妈妈在这一点上有几分道理。

somewhat adv. 有点；稍微

be right about 在……上是对的

²⁸ “But girls should also be **wise** enough to **take up**
challenges **when needed**.”

“但女孩子也应该足够明智，在需要时接受挑战。”

wise adj. 明智的

take up 接受（挑战等）；开始从事

challenge n. 挑战

when needed 在需要时

29 I **believe** you are **such a** girl.”

我相信你就是这样的女孩。”

believe v. 相信；认为

such a 这样的—一个

30 After that, I would never call Miss Chevalier “Poodle” again.

从那以后，我再也不叫谢瓦利埃小姐“卷毛狗”了。

after that 从那以后

poodle n. 卷毛狗；贵宾犬